

The AGORA

Adapted mixed-use development

The project is a response to a problem of abandoned industrial developments being a bog to urban developments hindering progress to the urban neighbourhood after they have served their fuction

The project is an adaptation of the adaptation of an abandoned industrial plant in Kikuyu town, Kiambu county _ Optimum Oil and Lubricant Factory.

The factory has gradually been shutting down functions since the early 2000s due to shifting economic times and cases of air pollution to the town. This led to closure in the 2010s and only some rooms are used for storage in the entire development.

The location of the factory in the heart of the town centre has led to a limitation in the commercial area that can be developed and is an oppportunity for a mixed-use development that can contribute to the larger urban revitalization.

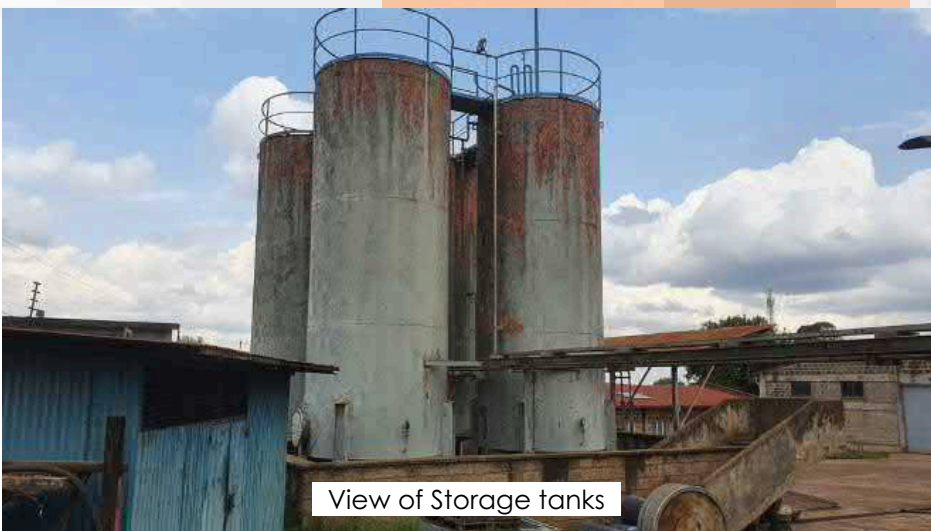
COMMERCIAL LAND USE LIMITATION, KIKUYU TOWN



View of Blending and filling station



View of Storage tanks



View of Storage tanks



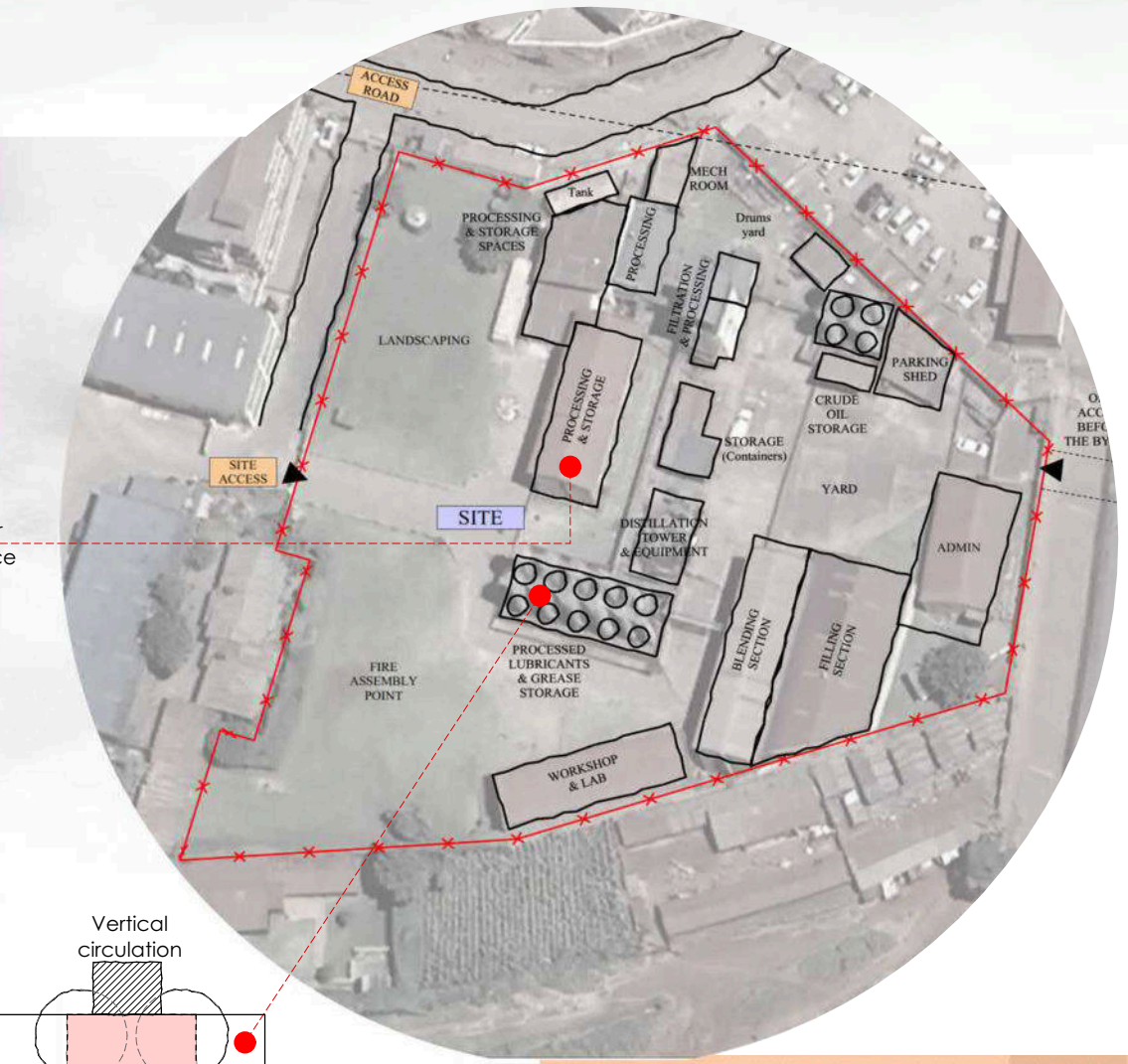
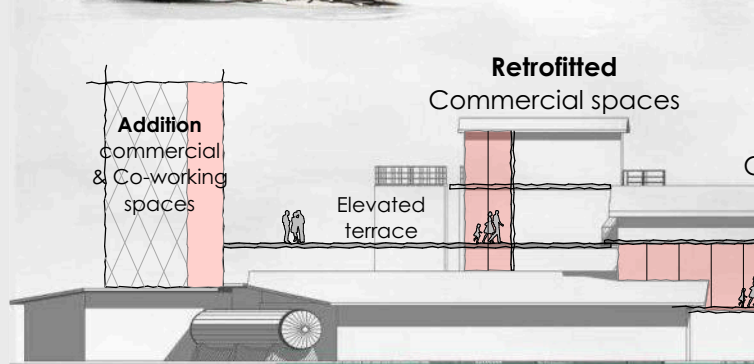
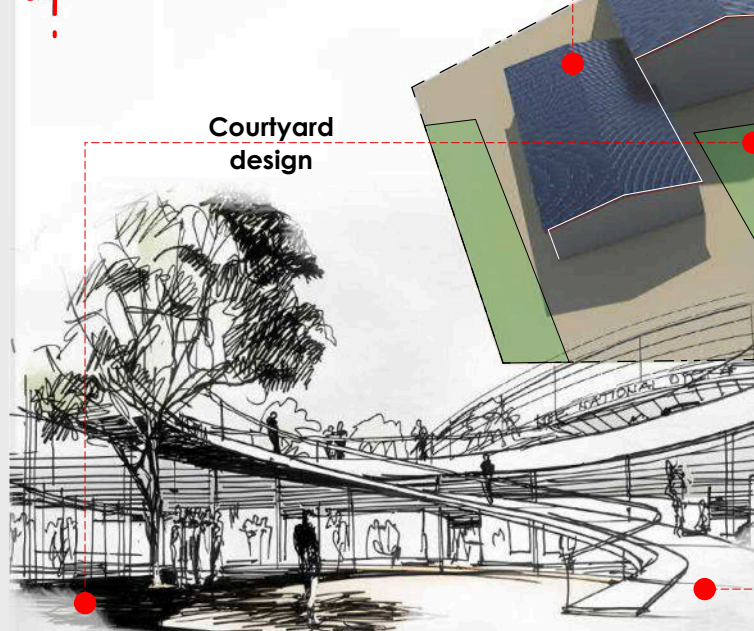
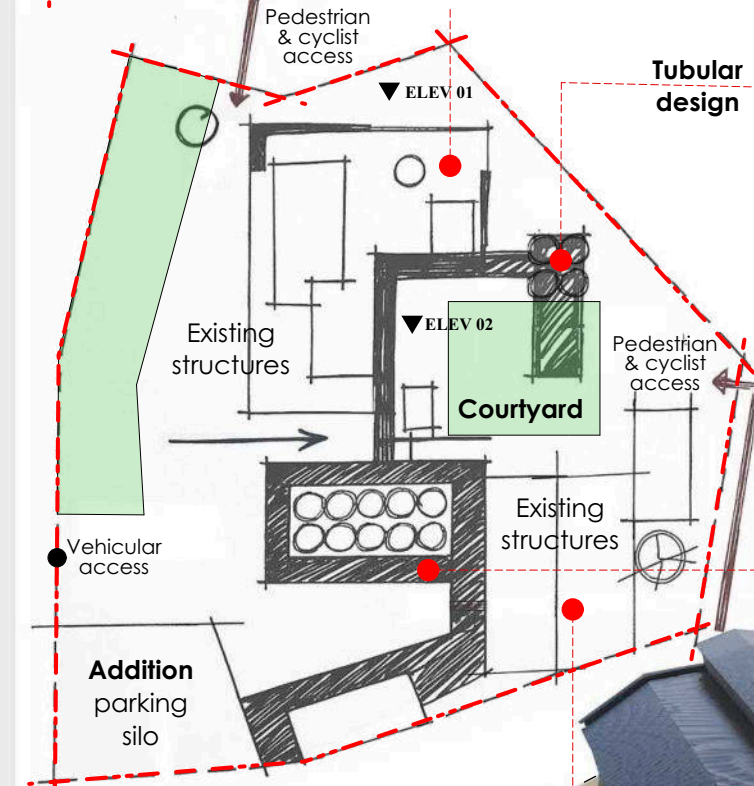
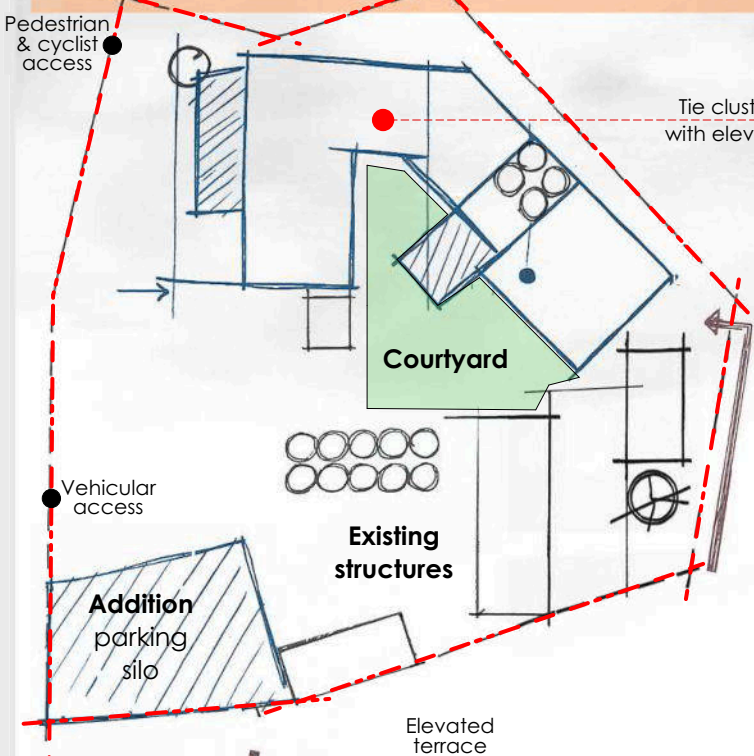
View of Filtration tower

View from access gate

CONCEPT: CONTINUITY WITH CHANGE

This concept approaches the development as an element of rejuvenation while retaining its historical past in the adaptation process.

The end goal is to re-imagine the existing developments with a contemporary look while retaining industrial aesthetic manifested through structural expressionism and guided by the best practices of conservation in adaptive reuse. This will be achieved by retaining as much as possible in the adaptation process with explicitness of the alterations.

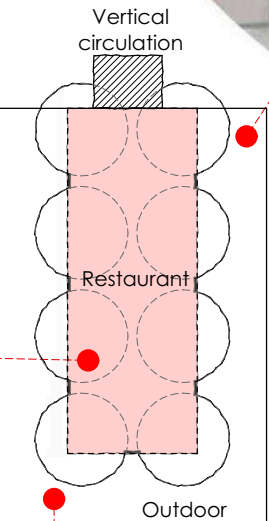


DESIGN PHILOSOPHY: STRUCTURAL EXPRESSIONISM

Structural expressionism is a design philosophy that explicitly expresses a building's structure as a key part of its aesthetic. It emerged in the mid-20th century as a reaction against purely decorative styles. (Pevsner, 1960)

Instead of hiding the framework of a building, structural expressionism puts it on display, often highlighting elements like steel beams, trusses, and service systems. This approach emphasizes honesty in materials, meaning that the materials used are presented in their natural state without being hidden or disguised. (Jencks, 1984)

The philosophy values the inherent beauty and integrity of materials like raw concrete, exposed steel, and unpainted wood.



Tubular design

ELEV 01

ELEV 02

Courtyard

Existing structures

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural systems & services

Elevated walkways & Terraces

Retrofitted Commercial spaces

Retrofitted Restaurants & Terrace

Additional parking silo

Vertical circulation

Restaurant

Outdoor dining

Pedestrian & cyclist access

Vehicular access

Additional parking silo

Exposed structural

The AGORA

Adapted mixed-use development

CONSERVATION BEST PRACTICES AND INTERVENTIONS

- Minimal intervention
- Retained industrial heritage
- Retention of patina
- Retention of scale
- Material authenticity

New parking
silo

Public plaza

Proposed
arcade

Elevated
terrace

Pedestrian
& Cyclist access

Existing
structures

Landscaped
park

Public plaza

Open
vending

Courtyard

Exposed structural systems
& services

Pedestrian
& Cyclist access

Designed pedestrian
zone

Existing rhythm
by size pattern

1500 Sqm plinth

Existing
structure

Existing
structures

Minimal alteration

CASE STUDY RECOMMENDATIONS

- Mixed-use approach
- Community & social value
- Reversibility
- Flexibility & Adaptability
- Harmonic contrast in material (Old and new)
- Pedestrian focus
- Sustainability emphasis

Retrofitted
Restaurants

Elevated
terrace

Retained industrial
machinery & pipework

Vibrant coloured
retrofitted spaces

Frontage extension
(Harmonic contrast)

Existing rhythm
by size pattern

Vibrant art mural feature walls
(Harmonic contrast)

Elevated
terrace

Contemporary looking
Frontage extension
(Harmonic contrast)

Commercial
spaces

Stair to terrace

Accessibility
ramp to terrace

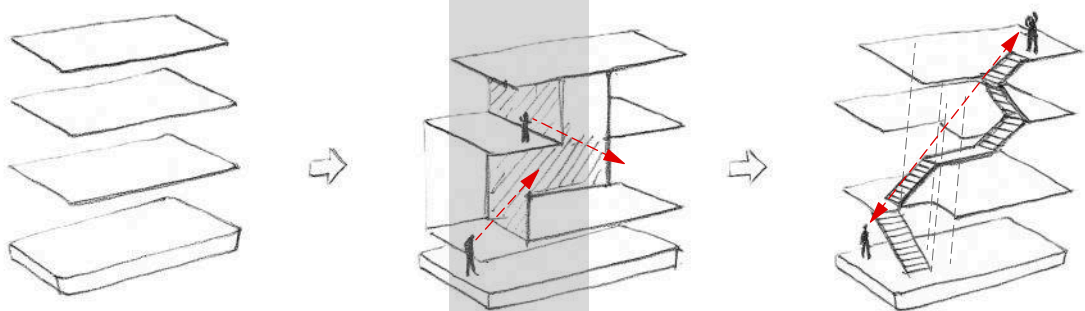
Vendors on
existing containers

Retained
pipework

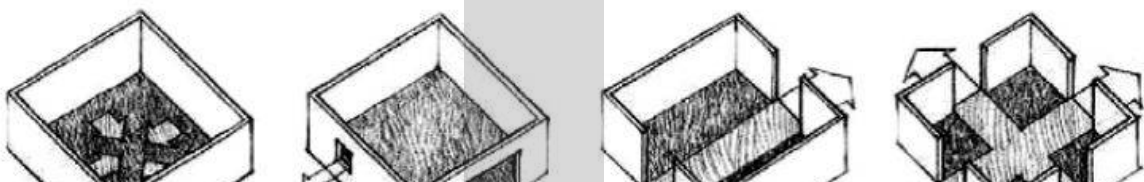
Elev 02

PROJECT INFO

- Location** - Kikuyu town, Kiambu
Current ownership - Optimum Oil & Lubricant Ltd.
Project financing - Joint public-private partnership
- Optimum Oil & Lubricant Ltd.
 - County Government of Kiambu
 - Invited shareholders



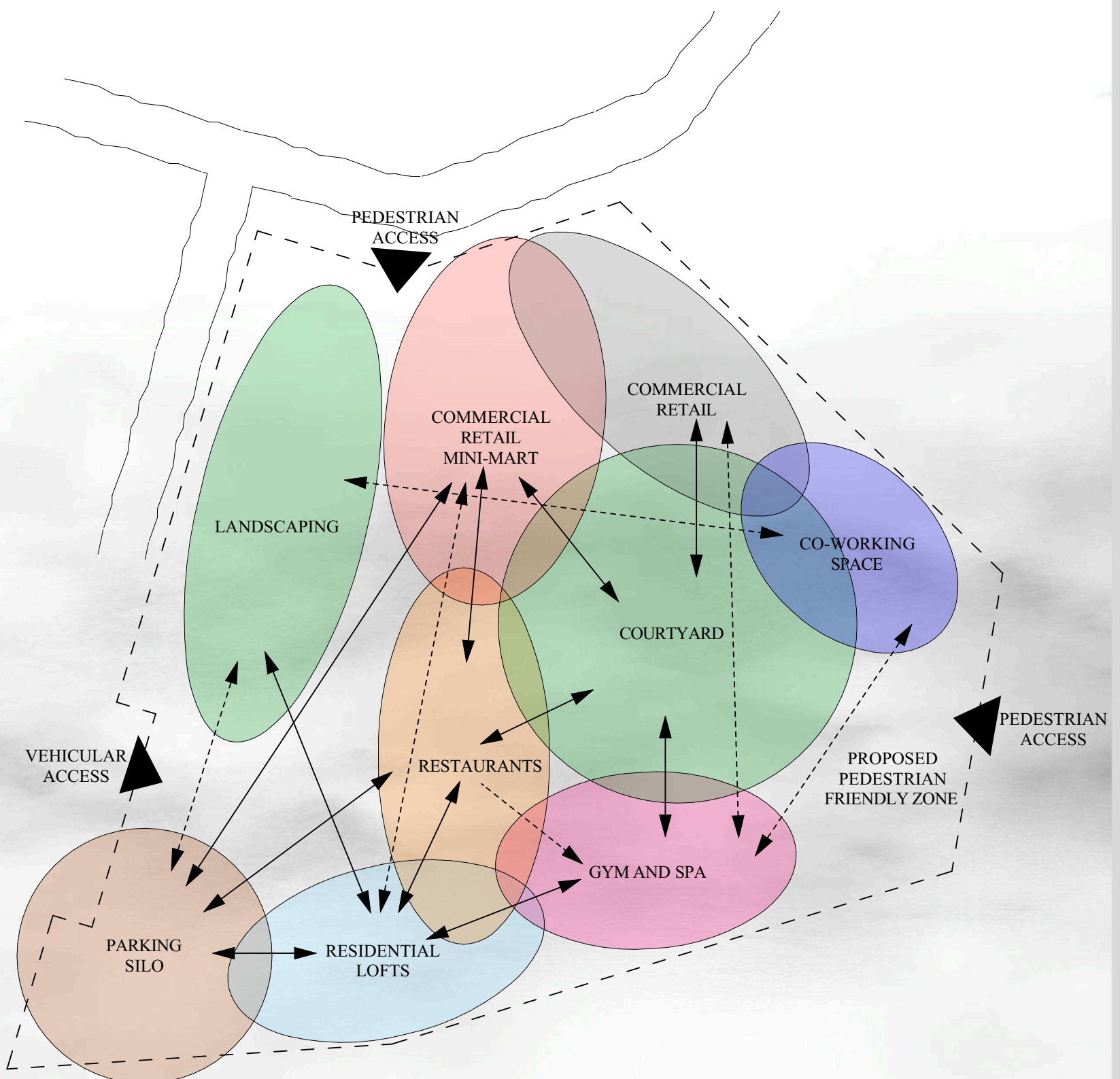
Interplay of volumes for inter-visibility



Balance of openness and enclosure



Courtyard concept



The AGORA

Adapted mixed-use development

a) Access and circulation

SPACE	GRAPHIC/VISUAL	CONDITION ANALYSIS
County government maintained tarmac road with side walk		CONDITION - GOOD - Presence of sidewalk - Presence of storm water drain. - 3m reserve - Parking and temporary structures on the sides - Power lines and sewer on the reserve
Machine-cut masonry perimeter wall with electric fence		CONDITION - FAIR - Good condition structurally - Inverted - 3m high - Waste and urination around the perimeter.
Steel hinged gate, painted and branded.		CONDITION - BAD - Rusty and corroded gate - Chipped paintwork
Former access road gate facing the Southern-Bypass		CONDITION - BAD - Inverted 'back side' - Left a tiny footpath between boundary wall and the Southern bypass. - Leaking sewer and drains into the highway

Building typologies based on condition

LEGEND

Very bad Bad Fair Good Very good

Workshop & laboratory 25x8.5m 3.5m H.R (Pitch roof) H = 5.5m		CONDITION - FAIR - Intact structure - Accrued patina (1980) - Partial corrosion on doors, roof and window frames - Oil stains on floor - Stained glazing - Most window panes intact - Faded paint on walls
Blending station 23x10m 3m H.R (2 floors) H= 10m		CONDITION - FAIR - Intact structure - Accrued patina (1980) - Partial corrosion on doors, roof and window frames - Oil stains on floor - Stained glazing - Most window panes intact - Faded paint on walls
Admin block 10x15m 4m Height (Pitched roof) H= 10m		CONDITION - FAIR - Intact structure - Accrued patina (1980) - Partial corrosion on doors, roof and window frames - Stained glazing - Most window panes intact - Faded paint on walls
Storage & processing near entrance 26x10m 3.5m H.R -2 floors (Gable Pitch roof) H = 9m		CONDITION - FAIR - Intact structure - Accrued patina (1980) - Partial corrosion on doors, roof and window frames - Stained glazing - Most window panes intact - Faded paint on walls

Building typologies based on construction period

Initial buildings - 1985 Later additions - 1995 Later additions - 2003 Later additions - 2010

SPACE	GRAPHIC/VISUAL	CONDITION ANALYSIS
Filling station (Later addition) 2010 23x14m 6m H.R -2 floors (GablePitch roof) H = 7m		CONDITION - GOOD - Intact structure - Unfinished walls - Doors, roof and window frames in good condition - Most window panes intact - Newer addition
Filtration tower (Later addition) 2010 8x4m 4m H.R - 4 floors (Gable-Pitch roof) H= 13m		CONDITION - GOOD - Intact steel structure - Oil stains - Doors, roof and window frames in good condition - Patchy corrugated sheets at the top - Most window panes intact - Newer addition
Storage tanks (1985) Additions-2003 R= 1.8m, 1.5m H= 9m, 6m 1.8m high overflow pit		CONDITION - FAIR - Intact structure - Eroded base on overflow pit - Patina - Flaked paint on tank walls - Rusted fastening components
Paving Cabro, Prefabricated concrete slabs		CONDITION - GOOD - Accrued patina - Usable condition - Oil stains - Intact paving blocks
Landscaping Grass and hedge		CONDITION - GOOD - Well-trimmed grass - Carved foot paths - Ingrown bushes behind buildings - Waste material stored on landscaping

Figure 4.26 Analysis of Internal Paving Source Photograph; Author, 2025

Figure 4.25 Landscaping view - Manicured grass Source Photograph; Author, 2025

Figure 4.24 Backyard view- Waste drum storage Source Photograph; Author, 2025

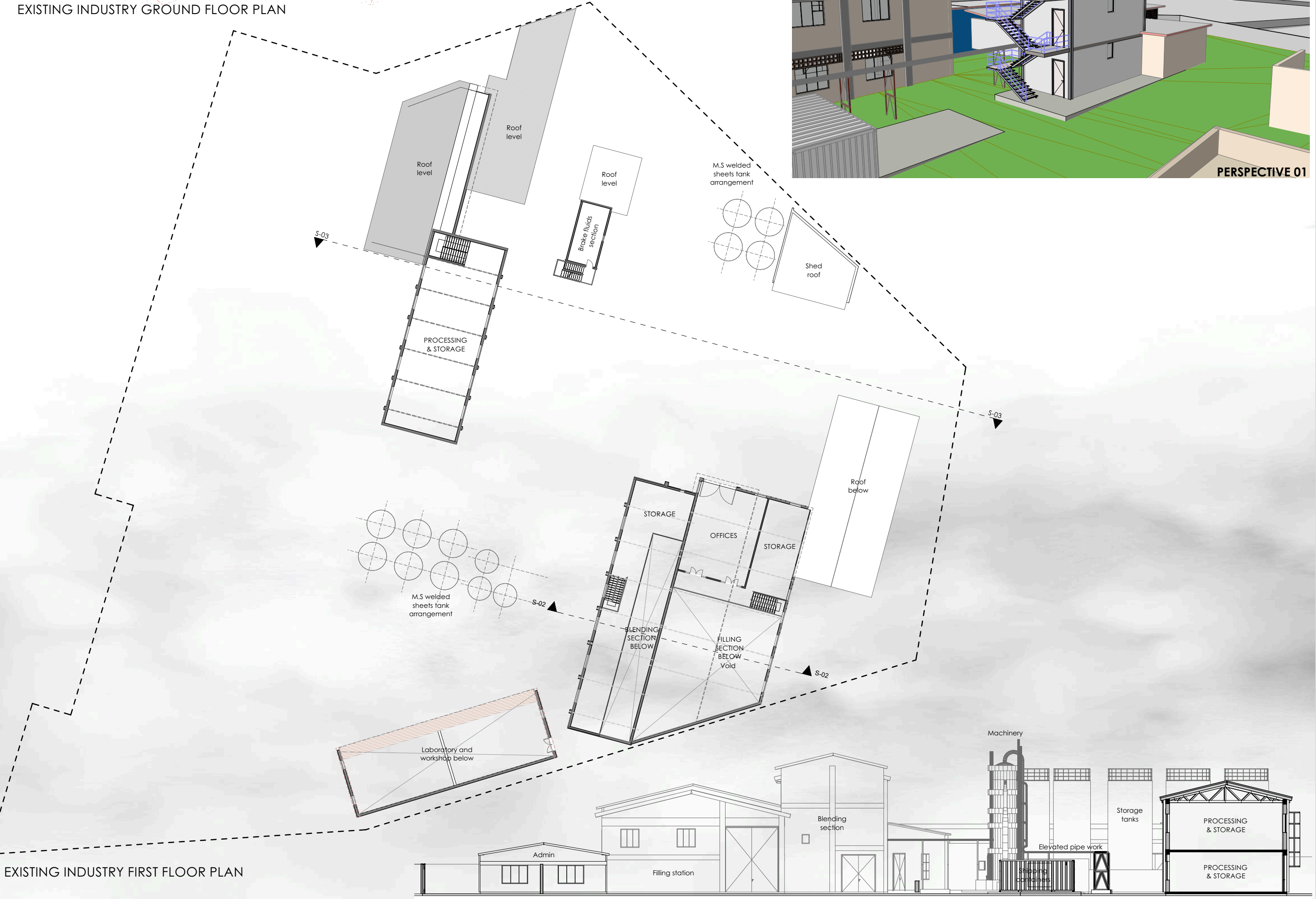
The AGORA
Adapted mixed-use development

EXISTING GROUND FLOOR PLAN

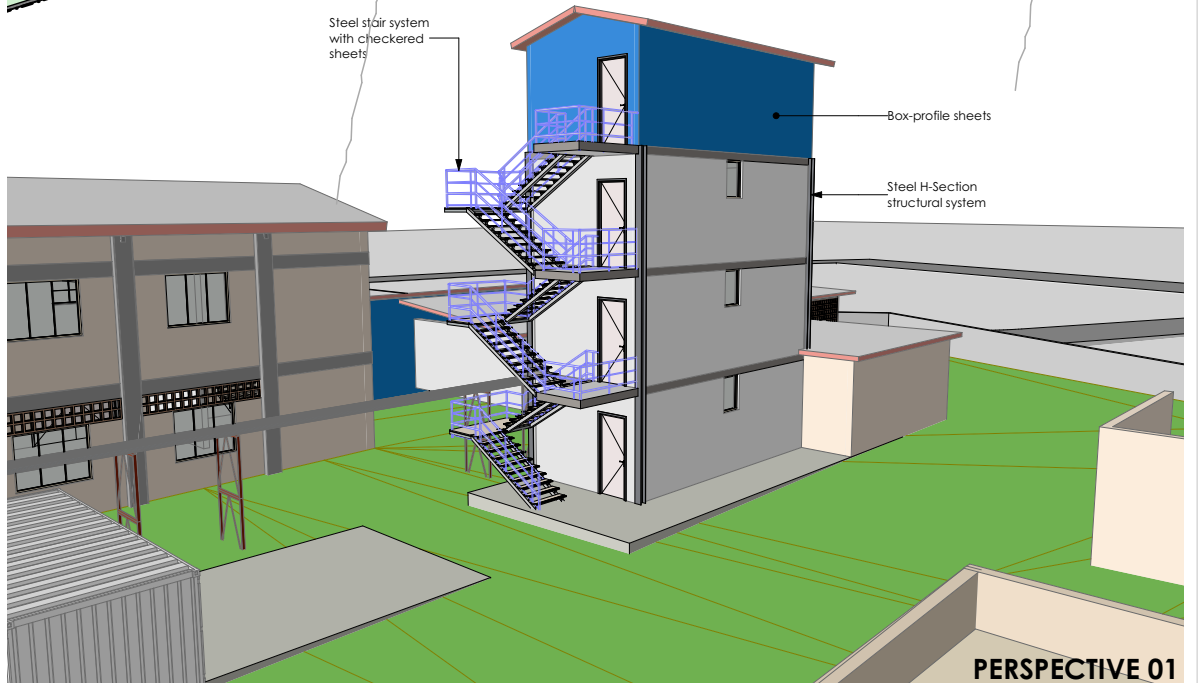


EXISTING INDUSTRY GROUND FLOOR PLAN

EXISTING FIRST FLOOR PLAN



EXISTING INDUSTRY FIRST FLOOR PLAN



EXISTING GROUND FLOOR PLAN

EXISTING PERSPECTIVE

B.A.R.C.H V.I 2025

The AGORA

Adapted mixed-use development

NEW PROPOSAL

LEGEND	
	Access roads
	New works
	Demolitions
	Existing works

APARTMENTS

PUBLIC ROAD

CAR YARD

FURNITURE
INDUSTRY

LOW-RISE
DEVELOPMENT

SOUTHERN
BYPASS

GROUND FLOOR/SITE PLAN

NEW PROPOSAL GROUND FLOOR

NEW PROPOSAL

LEGEND	
	Access roads
	New works
	Demolitions
	Existing works



FIRST FLOOR PLAN

FOCUS
SPACE

NEW PROPOSAL FIRST FLOOR

B.ARCH VI 2025

The AGORA

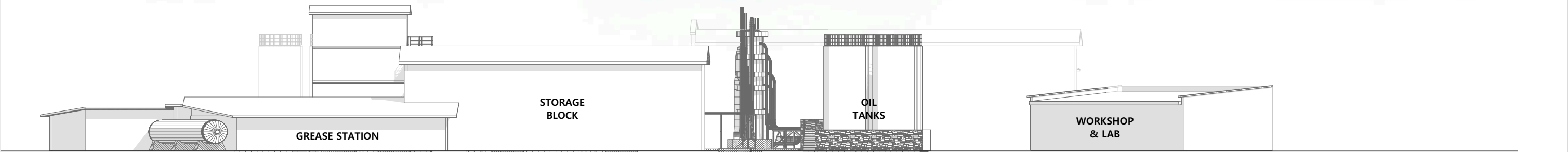
Adapted mixed-use development

NEW

OLD

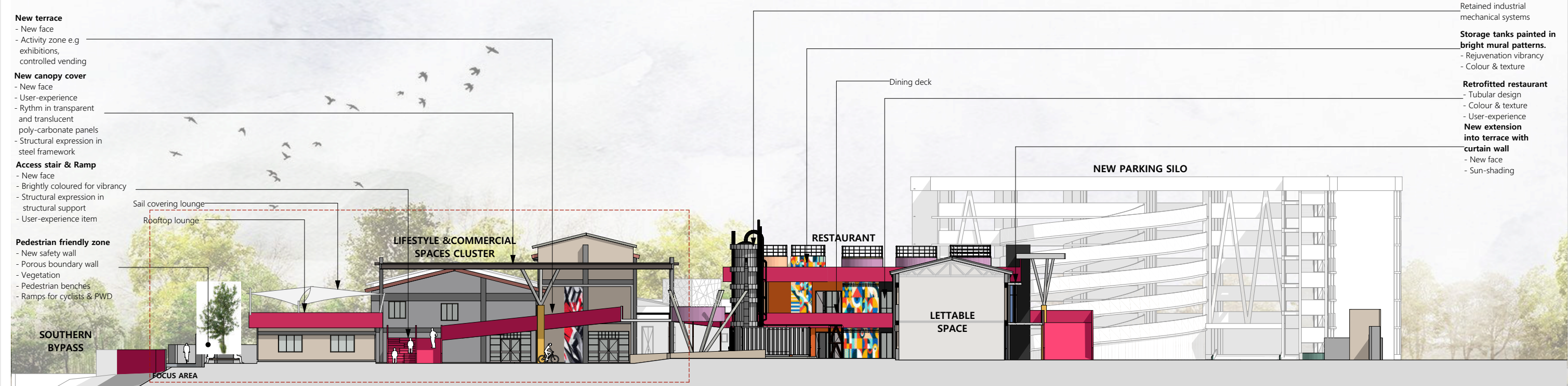


ELEVATION 01 NEW



ELEVATION 01 AS-BUILT

NEW



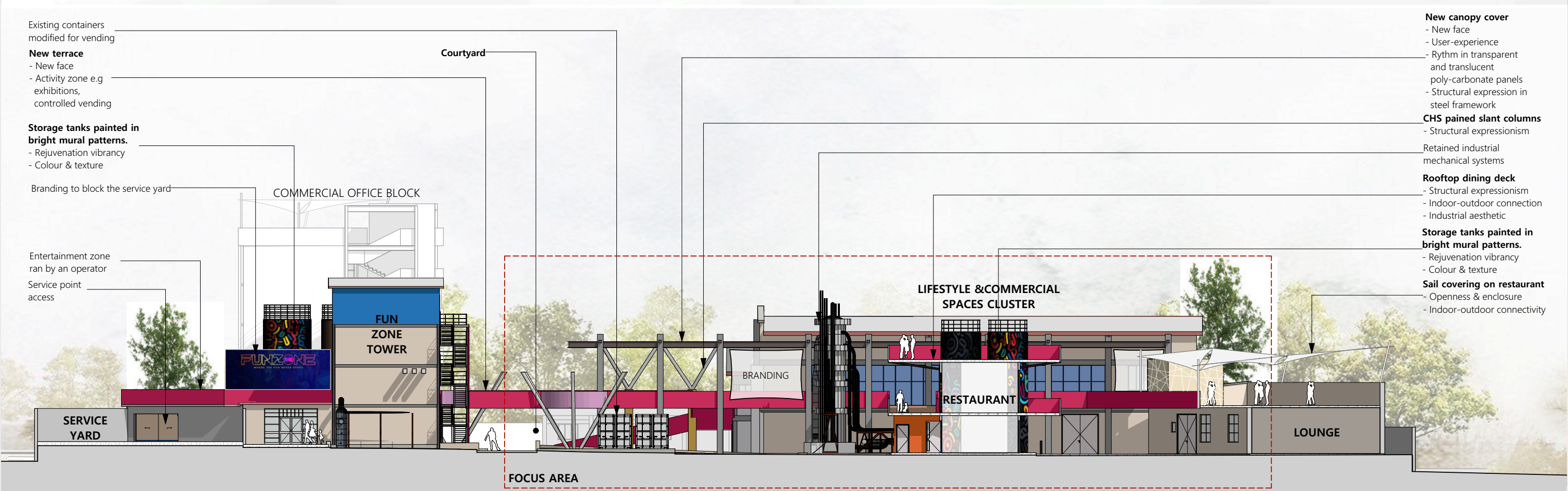
SECTIONAL ELEVATION 01

NEW



SECTIONAL ELEVATION 02

NEW



SECTIONAL ELEVATION 03

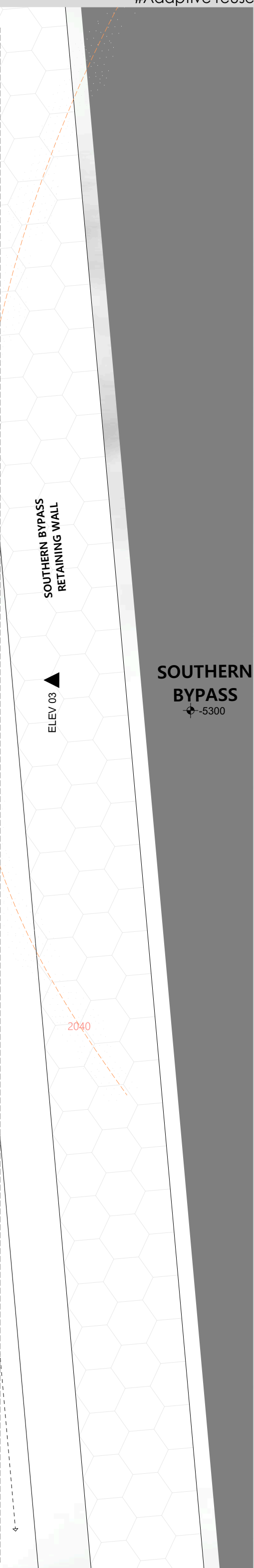
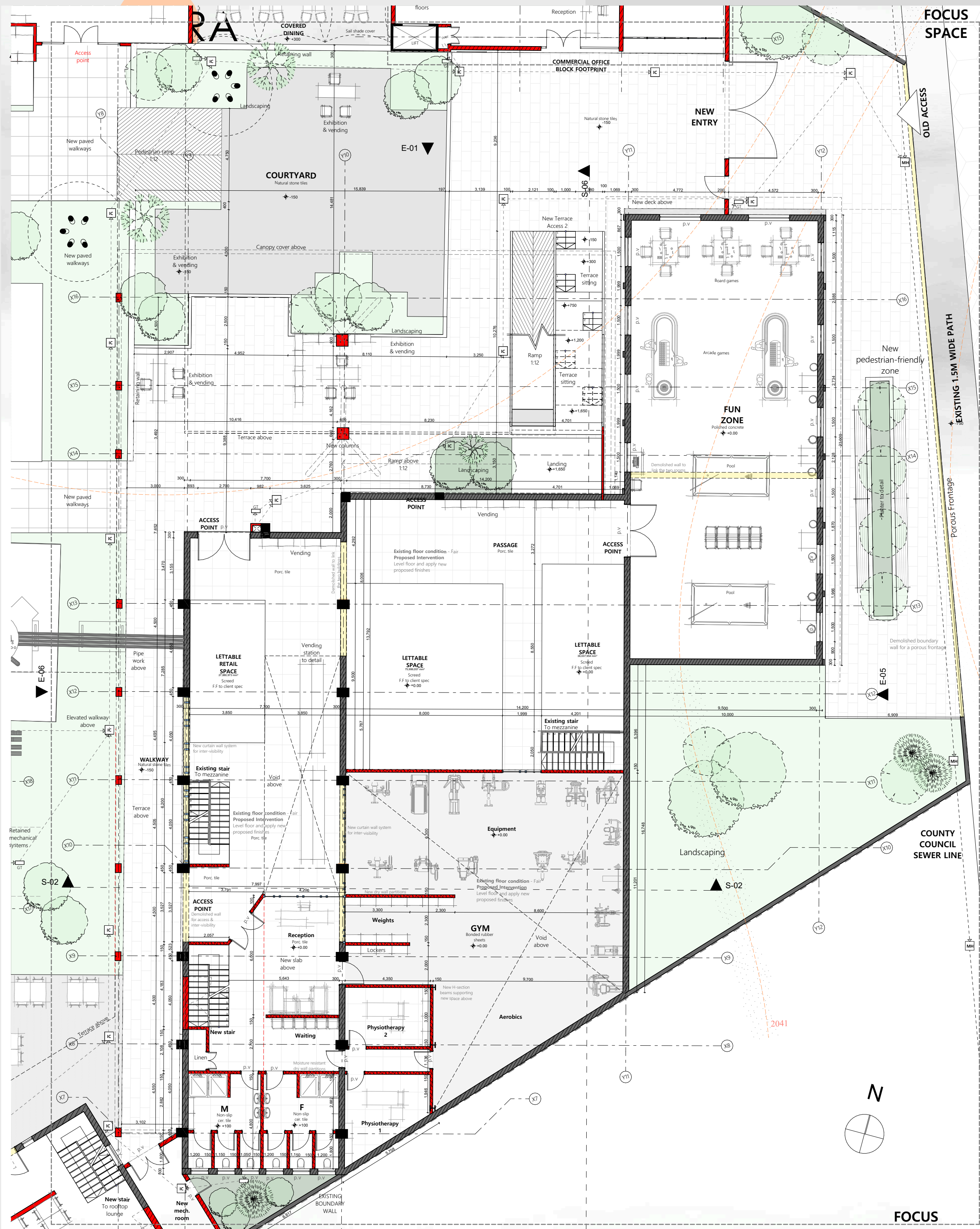
COMPARATIVE ELEVATION

SECTIONAL ELEVATION

SECTIONAL ELEVATION

SECTIONAL ELEVATION

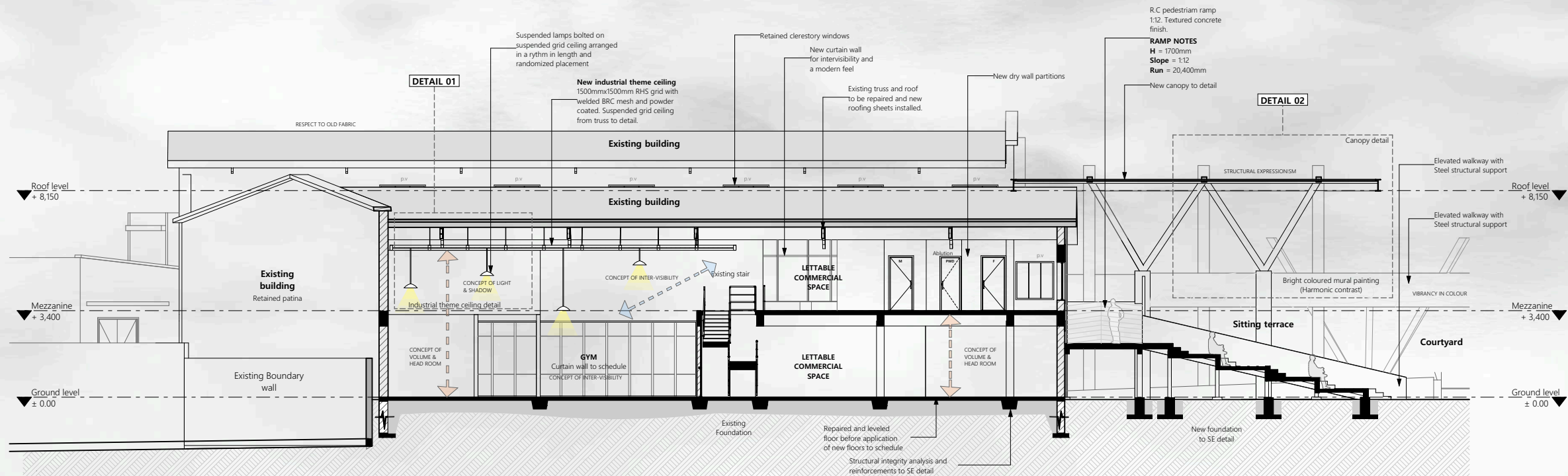
B.A.R.C.H V I 2025



LEGEND

- Existing masonry walls
- Existing structural members
- Demolitions on existing walls
- Filled walls on existing openings
- New 200mm masonry walls on drainage walls
- New 75-100mm Drywall partitions
- New R.C columns

LIFESTYLE AND WELLNESS CLUSTER PLAN



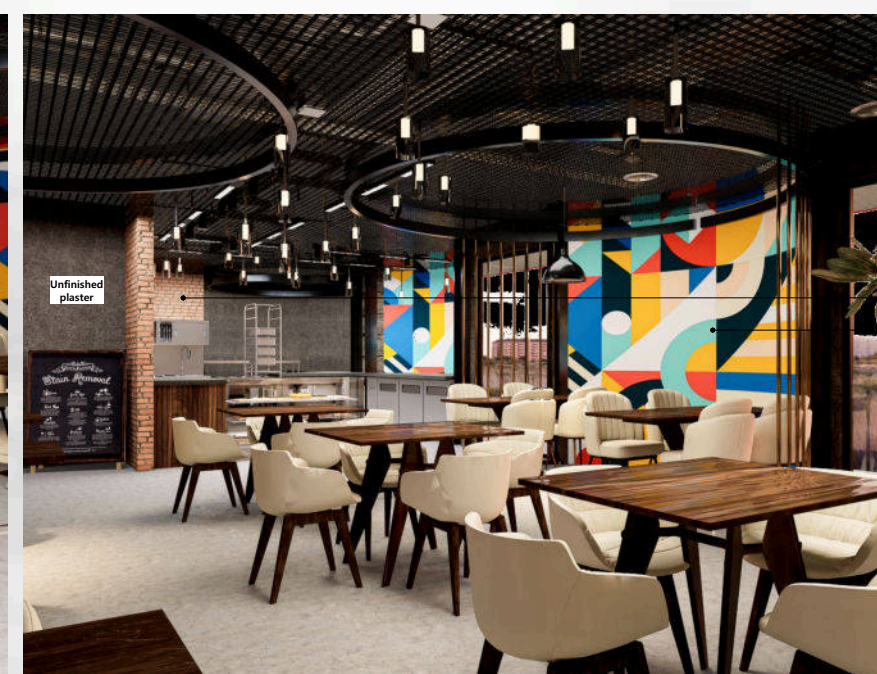
SECTION 06

The AGORA
Adapted mixed-use development

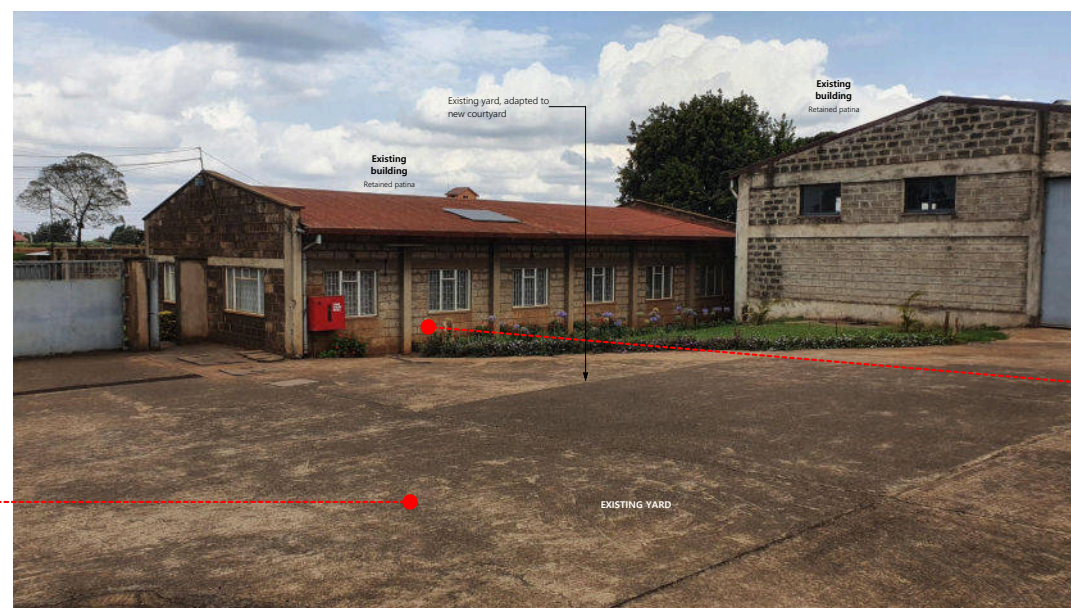
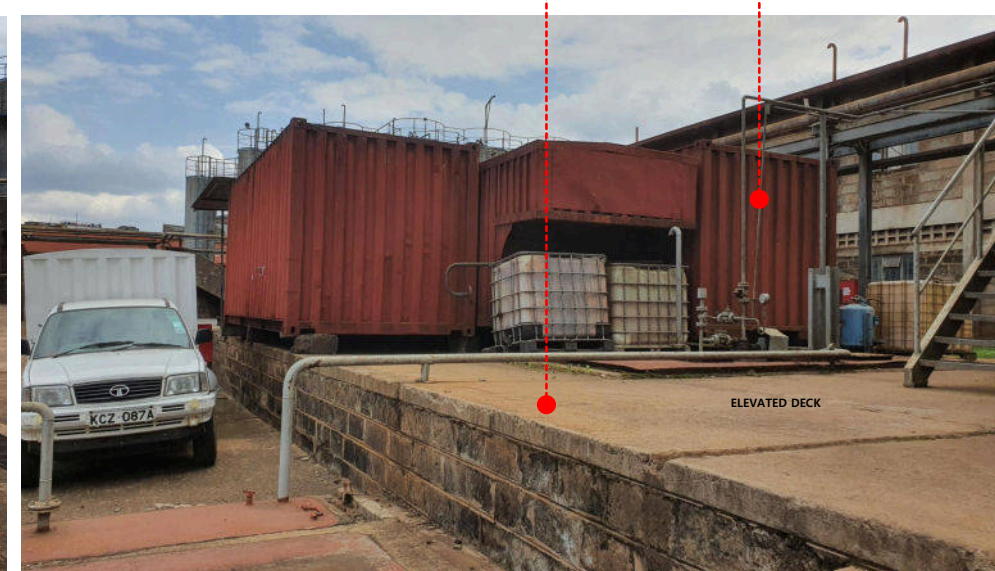
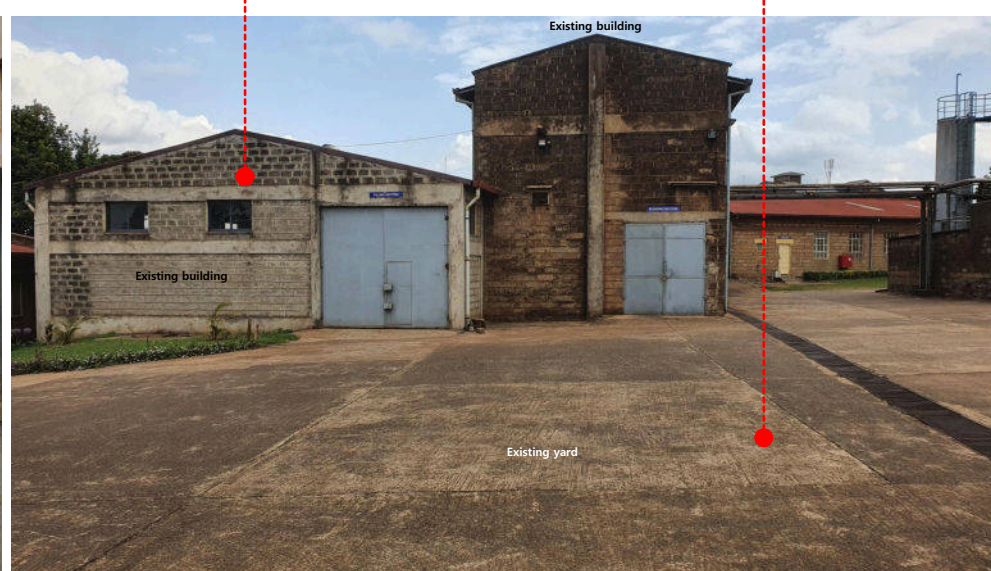
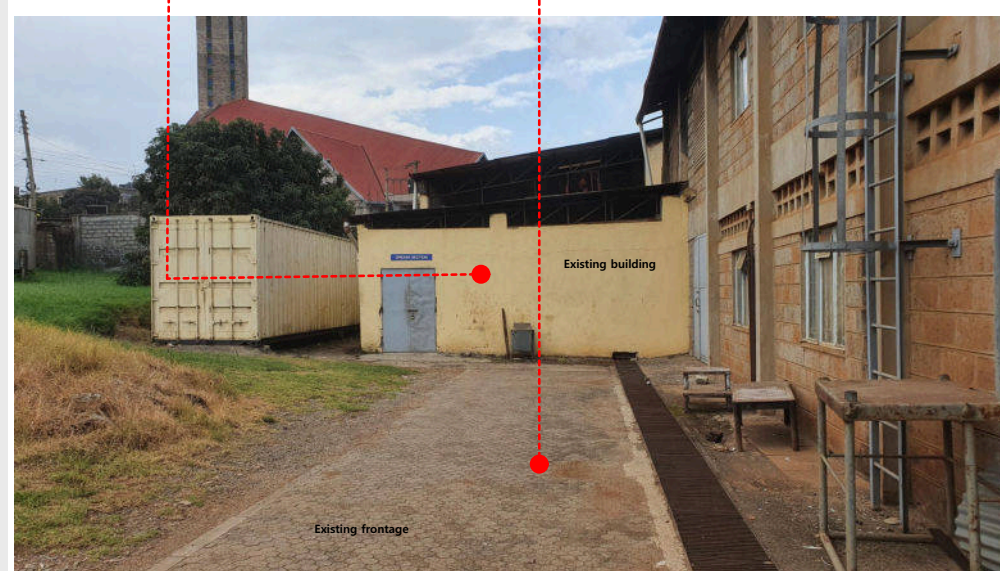
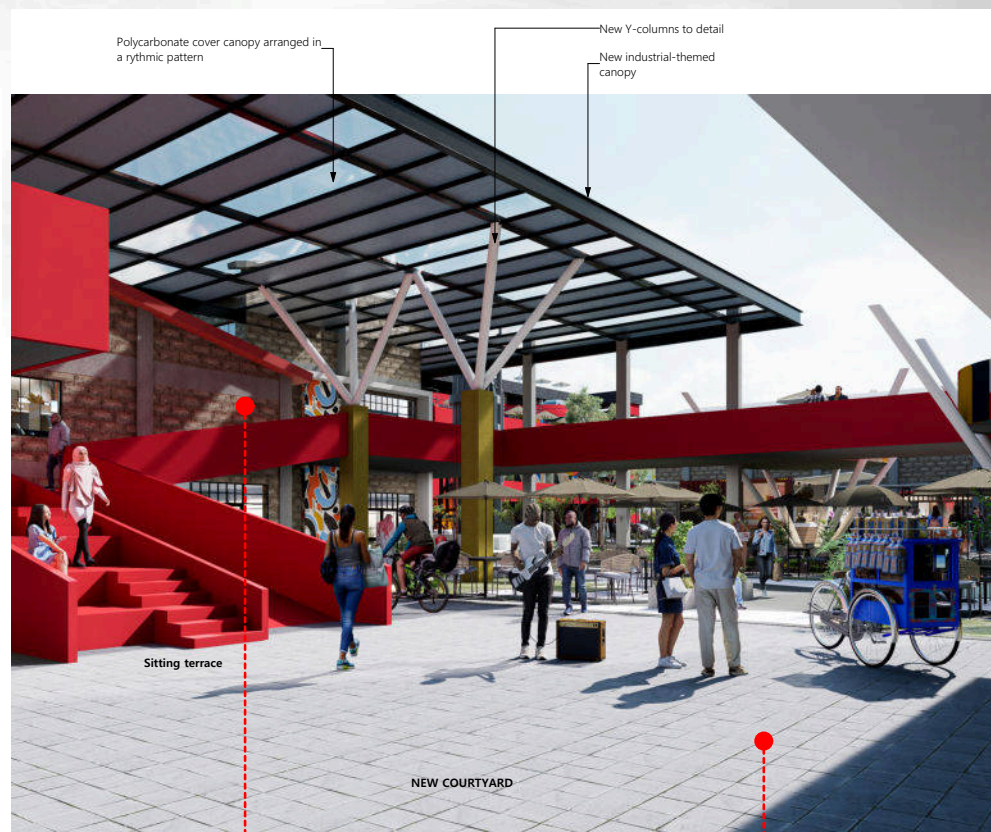
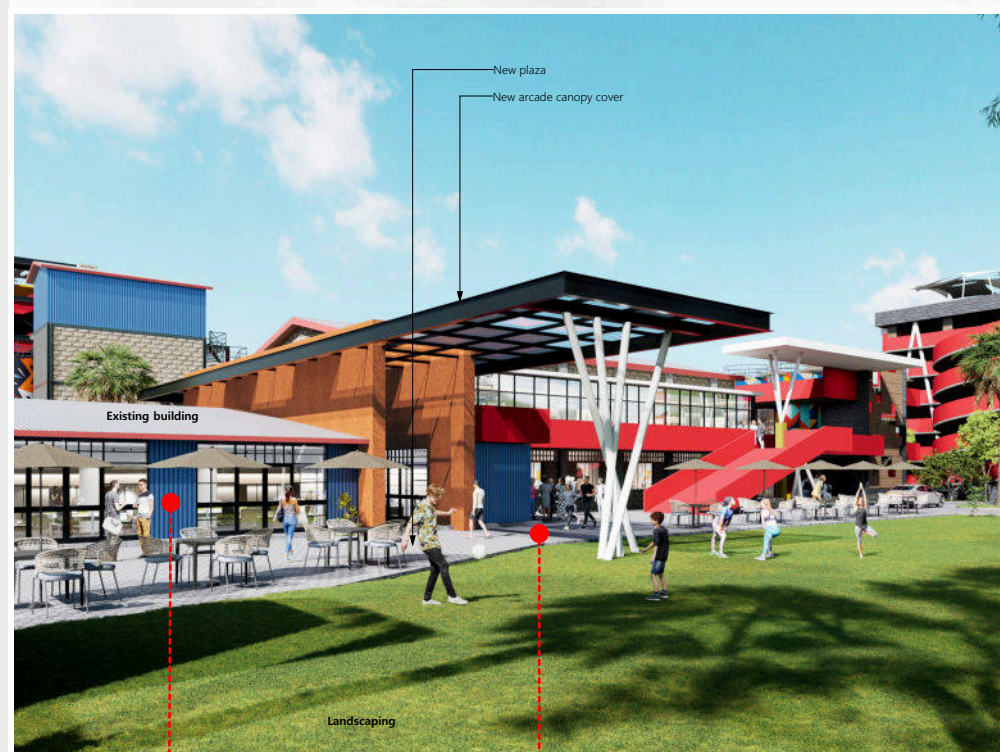
ADAPTED CAFE



CAFE INTERIOR RENDERS



CAFE INTERIOR RENDERS



VIBRANT MIXED-USE DEVELOPMENT

VIBRANT MIXED-USE DEVELOPMENT

ABANDONED INDUSTRY

ABANDONED INDUSTRY

COMPARATIVE RENDERS

COMPARATIVE RENDERS